IXIGO TRAINS · PRODUCT CAPSTONE

Supporting Artifacts

Best Way to Reach: turning a waitlisted ticket into a travel plan people trust

Rohit Kumar · Airtribe Product Management Launchpad · 6 November 2026

Deliverable	Link
Final presentation deck (PDF)	Rohit_Kumar_Product_Capstone.pdf (submitted separately)
Video walkthrough	Rohit_Kumar_Product_Capstone.mp4 (submitted separately)
Prototype (Lovable) – Prototype_Rohit_Kumar_Product	https://best-way-to-reach.lovable.app
AI Trip Resolver demo	https://claude.ai/artifact/KPxNPimZcUWhTTiMVHkK7B
Step 1 research doc	https://claude.ai/artifact/N44ZFHRrTX9A8tSE4TPxAY
Problem, solution and PRD doc (Steps 2–8)	https://claude.ai/artifact/XrM8yHwwUGXVJE8sBA51Pi

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1 · Interview log

21 interview records (20 calls and chats, about 20 unique people) plus 7 survey respondents: about 27 users in total. Insights are paraphrased; several call transcripts were noisy, so each record carries an evidence label (how clearly the recording supports the insight). Record 12 may be the same person as record 07. Survey respondents are anonymised (S01–S07).

#	Name	Type	Channel	Route / context	Key insight	Evidence
01	**Shashikant Kumar**	Unclear (ixigo + IRCTC)	Call	ixigo and IRCTC bookings	Waitlist uncertainty; wants to know what to do if a ticket doesn't confirm	Low
02	**Prince**	Active ixigo user	Call	Train + hotel; family and friends; connecting trips	Values the confirmation % and 3X Refund; books for others	Low
03	**Amrish**	Unclear	Call	ixigo vs IRCTC; Tatkal	Weighs Tatkal vs regular tickets, travel time vs cost	Low
04	**Diwakar**	Active ixigo user	Call	Bookings for his father	Wants clear WL/RAC status; general ticket as a fallback	Low
05	**Nitin Anuj**	Active ixigo user	Call	Mumbai; festival season	Needs alternatives in festival peaks; last-minute vs advance booking	Low
06	**Aditya**	Active ixigo user (2 yrs)	Call	Varanasi; family; 2AC	Trusts about 85–90%; comfort first; would take a flight or bus; didn't know 3X Refund	Good
07	**Diwakar Durlabh**	Active ixigo user	Call	Ahmedabad–Prayagraj	Books at about 80% chance; uses 3X Refund	Medium–Low
08	**Ashish**	Active ixigo user, 12–15 trips/yr	Call	Mumbai–Delhi	Books at 80%+ and often gets RAC; wants short, on-time night trains; checks IRCTC for data mismatches	Good
09	**Avi Anika**	IRCTC user (never booked on ixigo)	Call	Delhi–Prayagraj / Lucknow	Downloaded ixigo but books on official IRCTC	Good
10	**Anika**	MakeMyTrip user	Call	Delhi–Kanpur	On-time arrival comes first; books only at 80%+, else goes by car	Good
11	**Alok Vishwakarma**	IRCTC user	Call	Mumbai–Patna	Finds IRCTC easy; Tatkal and bus as alternatives	Low
12	**Durlabh***	Checks ixigo, books on IRCTC	Call	Patna–Delhi	Worried about extra charges, refund method and voucher terms	Low–Medium
13	**Priya**	Active ixigo user	Call	Punjab–West Bengal	Books WL only at 80%+; otherwise IRCTC / Premium Tatkal; avoids long flight layovers	Good
14	**Sayantika**	Active ixigo user	Call	Malda–Delhi; Durga Puja	Uses about 80%, 90% when urgent; plans ahead	Good

#	Name	Type	Channel	Route / context	Key insight	Evidence
15	**Sandeep Ghosh**	Using ixigo less	Call	Railway bookings	Wants 90–95%; a high-chance ticket didn't confirm; login friction cut his usage	Medium–Low
16	**Anup Mondal**	Active ixigo user	Call	Bangalore–Kolkata; family	Values timings, availability and sorting; flight as an alternative	Medium–Low
17	**Abhay**	IRCTC user	Call	Train tracking	General ticket as a last resort; bus and flight also considered	Very low
18	**Yashveer**	Using ixigo less	Call	Shiv Ganga Express; night travel	Finds ixigo more complicated than IRCTC	Low–Medium
19	**Abhilash**	Checks ixigo, books on IRCTC	Call	Varanasi–Delhi	Uses ixigo for information; books on IRCTC because it is official	Low
20	**Sushant**	Checks ixigo, books on IRCTC	Call	Bangalore–Darbhanga	Checks ixigo, books on IRCTC; 3X Refund unclear	Very low
21	**Mamta Singh**	Active ixigo user	WhatsApp	Mumbai–Agra; Rajdhani; family	Booked WL at 95%, confirmed about 4 h before departure; books only above 90%; prefers a flight to Tatkal; rates ixigo 4/5	Good
S01	**Survey respondent**	Uses IRCTC, ixigo, ConfirmTkt	Survey	Family function; 3–4 people; booked 1+ month ahead	Searched 3–5 times; got confirmed Tatkal on IRCTC; a high-chance ticket once ended as RAC; trust in % 2/5; top priority journey time	Survey
S02	**Survey respondent**	Uses 6 apps incl. ixigo	Survey	Holiday; 2 people; 2–7 days ahead	Tatkal stayed WL, so flew (booked on ixigo); trust 1/5; too many options to compare; top priority comfort	Survey
S03	**Survey respondent**	IRCTC, ixigo	Survey	No waitlist in the last 6 months	Screened out after Q1	Survey
S04	**Survey respondent**	IRCTC, ixigo, Paytm	Survey	Work; solo; same day	Confirmed Tatkal on ixigo after 3–5 searches; trust 1/5; found out too late; top priority journey time	Survey
S05	**Survey respondent**	IRCTC, ixigo, ConfirmTkt, agent	Survey	Festival; 3–4 people; 2–7 days ahead	Tried every option, searched 10+ times, finally used an agent; didn't trust the prediction; top priority confirmation	Survey
S06	**Survey respondent**	IRCTC, ixigo, MakeMyTrip	Survey	Work; solo; same day	Confirmed Tatkal on IRCTC; too many options to compare; trust 3/5; top priority arrival time	Survey
S07	**Survey respondent**	IRCTC only	Survey	Family function; 5+ people; 1+ month ahead	Searched 10+ times and asked family; booked on IRCTC; trust 1/5; wants a comfortable family train	Survey

2 · Screenshots from user conversations

Evidence that the conversations happened, shown with participants' permission.

Screenshots to be added: 2–3 images from user conversations (WhatsApp chat, call recordings).

3 · Competitor analysis

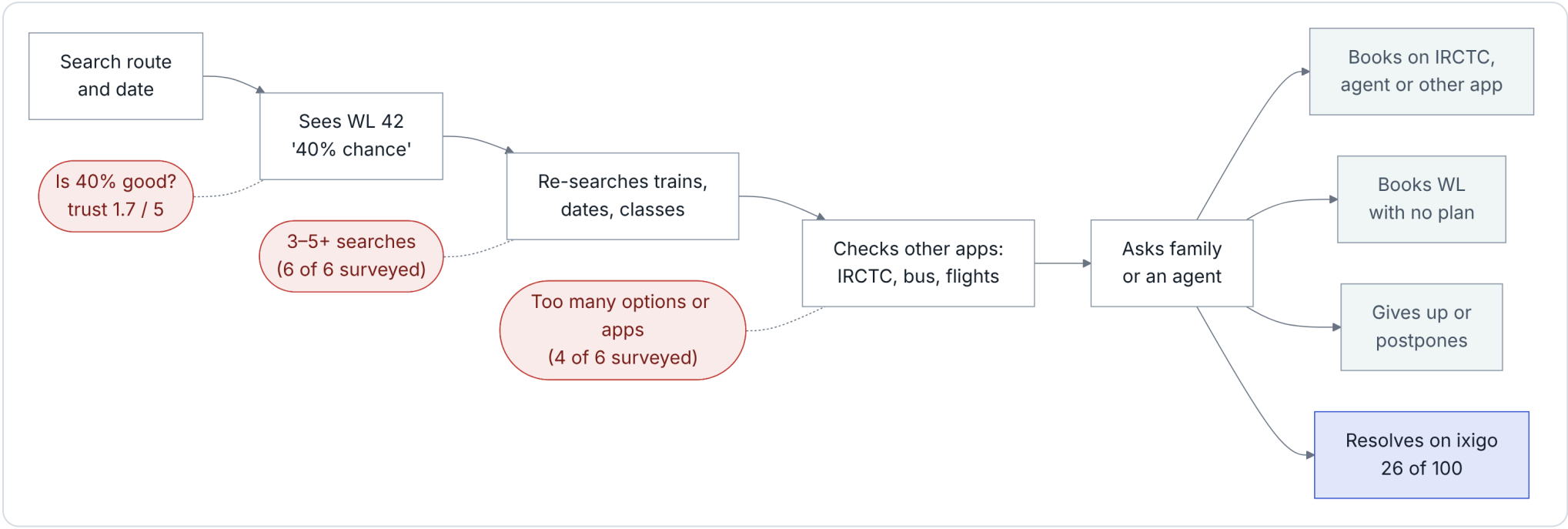
Every major player pairs a prediction with paid protection; none helps the user compare alternatives and choose.

Player	When the train is waitlisted	Strength	Gap for the user
ixigo Trains	Waitlist prediction; Alternate Travel Plan pays 3X (flight/bus) or 2X (train) value if the ticket stays WL; Assured free cancellation	Strong prediction (ConfirmTkt) plus cross-mode inventory	Refund mostly a coupon, selected trains only; the user still has to find and book the alternative
ConfirmTkt (ixigo group)	Alternates: other-station quota on the same train, two-train splits, train + bus	Finds hidden confirmed seats	Many raw options with no ranking by the user's priorities
IRCTC VIKALP	Free opt-in; auto-shift to another train on the same route if seats are free	Free, official	No choice after opting in; outcome known only at chart time
MakeMyTrip	Trip Guarantee 3X; same-train longer route and nearby-station suggestions	Smart route hacks in search	Trade-offs (arrival, station distance) not explained
redRail (redBus)	Confirmation probability; Alternate Trip add-on with 3X refund	Bus inventory built in	Protects money, not the journey
Airlines	Last-minute flights	Certain seat	Price spikes; not linked to the train search
Offline agents	Tatkal attempts, quota know-how, one clear answer	Trust and a single recommendation	Extra cost, no transparency

Sources: ixigo.com/trains/alternate-travel; YourStory (ConfirmTkt Alternates); LatestLY (IRCTC VIKALP); Travel Trends Today (MakeMyTrip); GrabOn (redRail Alternate Trip). Accessed October 2026.

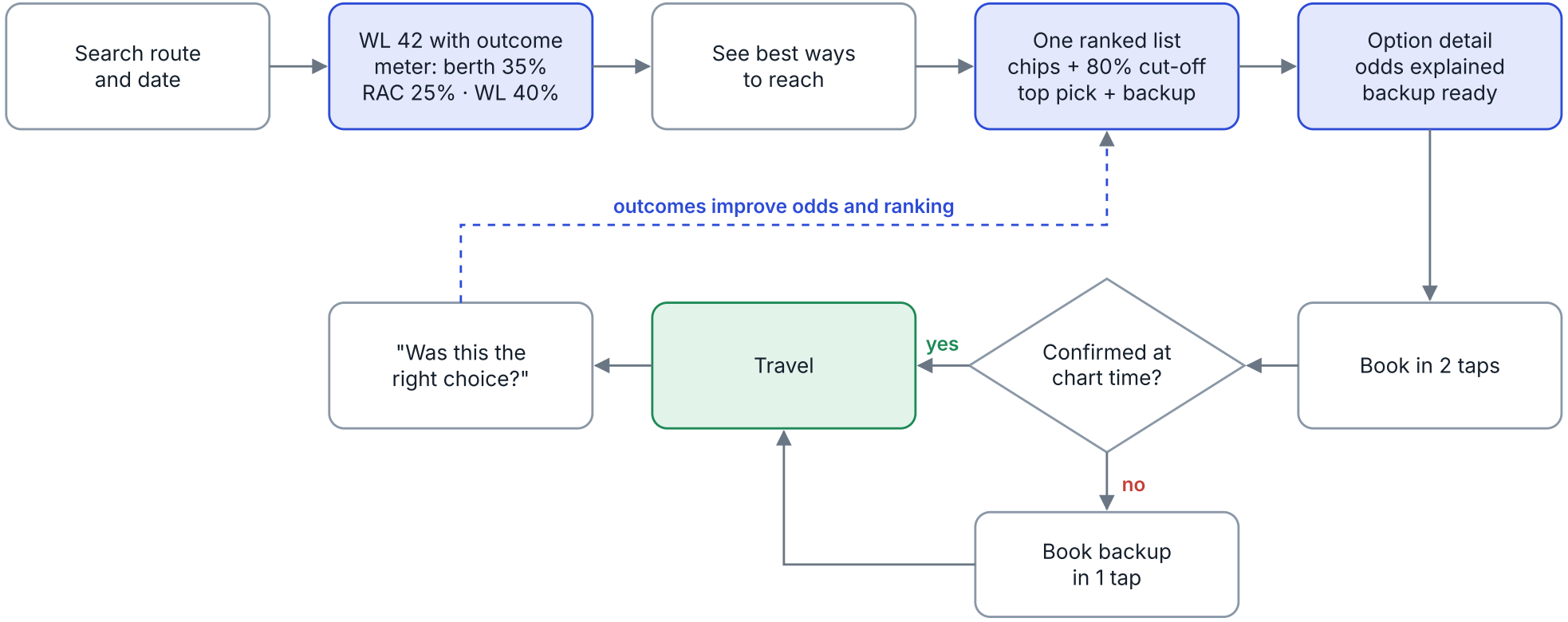
4a · UX flow today

Users bounce between searches, apps and people; red notes show the pain points measured in research.



4b · UX flow with Best Way to Reach

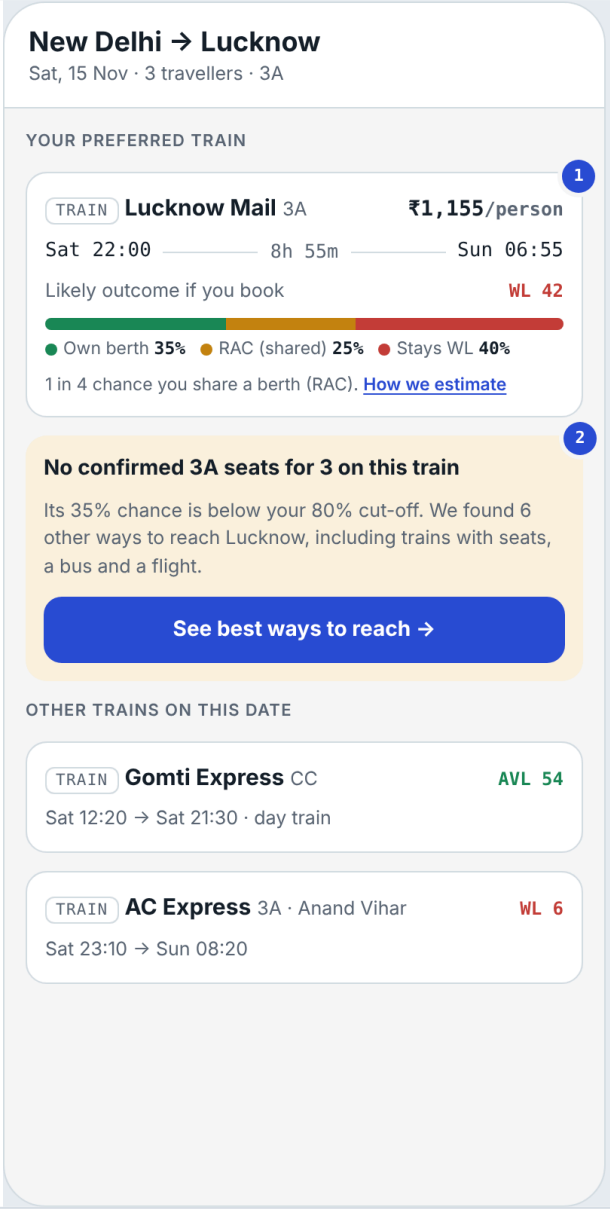
One ranked list, honest odds and a ready backup replace the loop; trip outcomes feed back into the ranking.



5 · PROTOTYPE · BEST-WAY-TO-REACH.LOVABLE.APP

Screen 1 · Search result with an honest outcome

The WL 42 train shows own berth 35% · RAC 25% · stays WL 40% (pin 1) and one entry point to every alternative (pin 2).



1 Search | 2 Best ways | 3 Detail | 4 Plan set

1 · Search result with an honest outcome

The user searched Delhi to Lucknow for 3 people. Their train is WL 42.

1 **Outcome meter instead of one "% confirm"**
Splits the outcome into own berth, RAC and stays WL. Research: 3 of 20 interviewees saw high odds end in RAC or WL, and survey trust in the % is 1.7 out of 5. Never says "guaranteed".

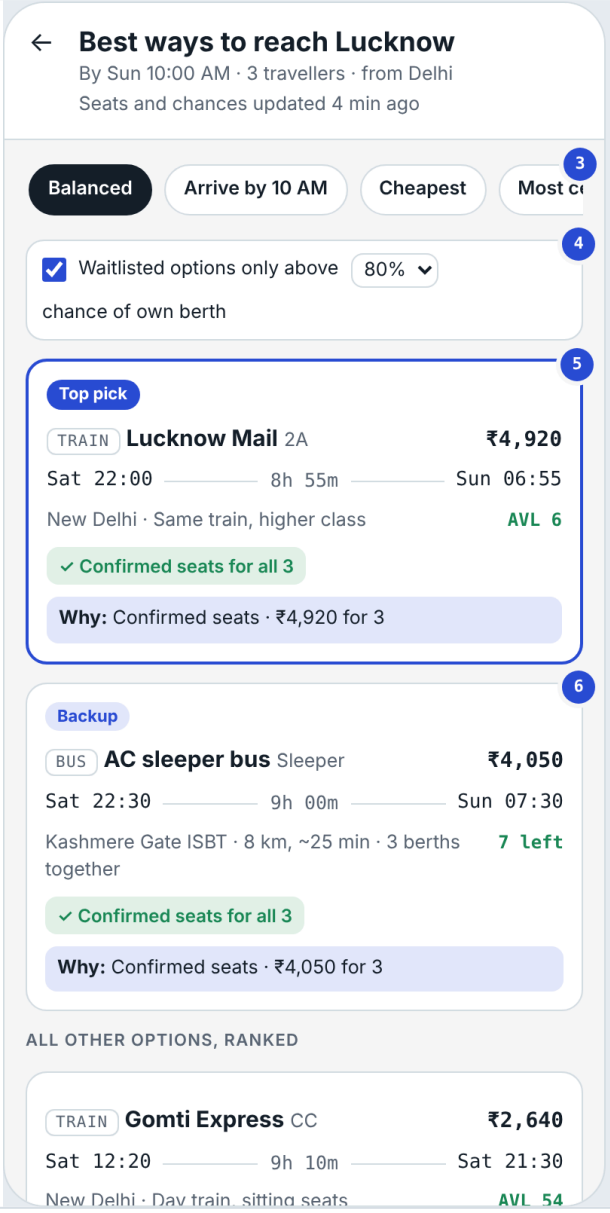
2 **Entry point at the moment of pain**
Shown only when the chosen class has no confirmed seats. Research: all 6 survey respondents searched 3+ times; 4 of 6 said too many options or apps was the hardest part.

Trains, fares and chances are sample values for the demo. Ranking logic: score = weighted sum of certainty, timing fit, price, journey time, station convenience and seats-together; the chip sets the weights.

5 · PROTOTYPE · BEST-WAY-TO-REACH.LOVABLE.APP

Screen 2 · Best ways to reach

Priority chips (3), the 80% cut-off filter (4), a top pick with its reason (5) and a confirmed backup (6).



1 Search | 2 Best ways | 3 Detail | 4 Plan set

2 · Best ways to reach

One ranked list across modes, with a top pick and a backup. Tap a chip or change the cut-off to see the ranking change.

3 Priority chips
6 of 20 interviewees named a different top priority (comfort, punctuality, speed, safety, timing). The chip changes the weights; the order updates instantly.

4 My cut-off filter
8 of 20 interviewees book a waitlisted ticket only above 80–95%. Long shots move to one line at the bottom, so nothing is hidden silently.

5 Top pick with a reason
A clear answer, like an agent or family member gives, plus the two factors that earned it the spot.

6 Backup always visible
If the top pick is waitlisted, the backup is always a confirmed option. Protection becomes a plan, not just a refund.

7 Your own train stays visible
Even below the cut-off, users see where their choice stands and why. No hidden upselling.

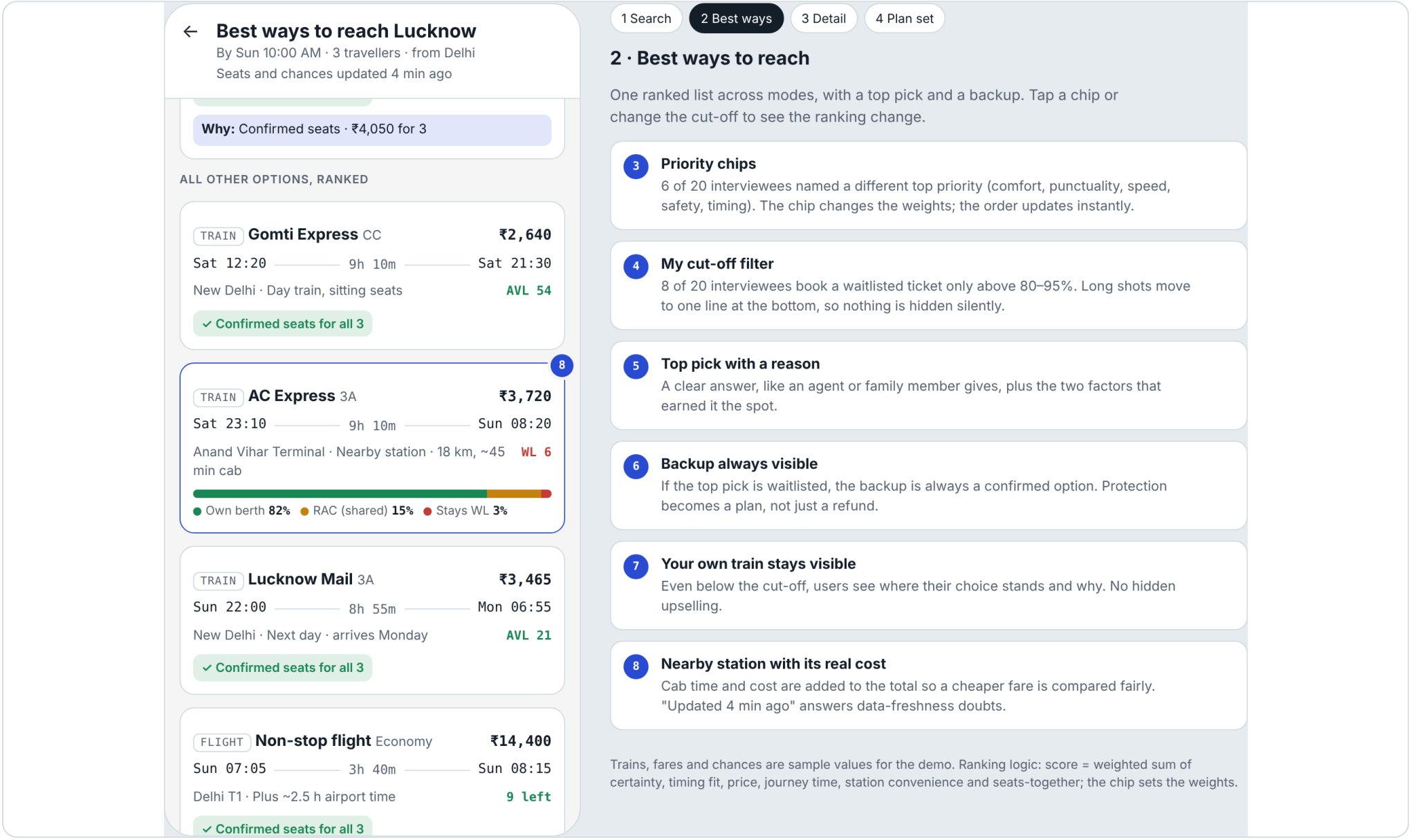
8 Nearby station with its real cost
Cab time and cost are added to the total so a cheaper fare is compared fairly. "Updated 4 min ago" answers data-freshness doubts.

Trains, fares and chances are sample values for the demo. Ranking logic: score = weighted sum of certainty, timing fit, price, journey time, station convenience and seats-together; the chip sets the weights.

5 · PROTOTYPE · BEST-WAY-TO-REACH.LOVABLE.APP

Screen 2 (scrolled) · Nothing hidden silently

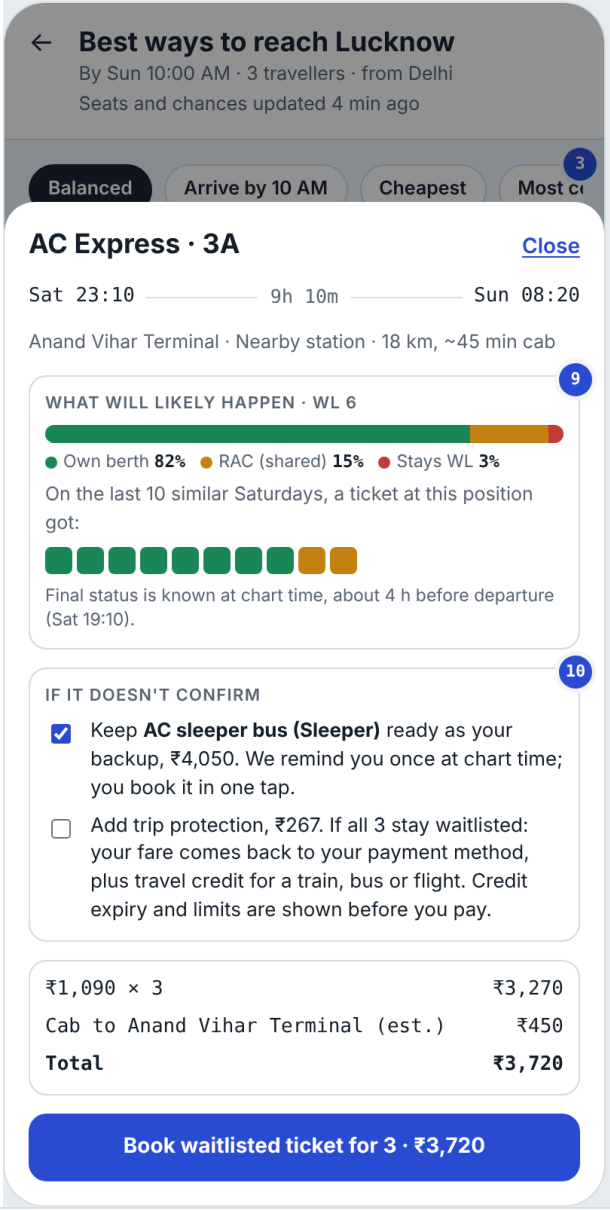
The nearby station carries its cab cost (8); options below the cut-off, including the user's own train (7), sit in one line at the bottom.



5 · PROTOTYPE · BEST-WAY-TO-REACH.LOVABLE.APP

Screen 3 · Option detail

The chance explained as the last 10 similar Saturdays (9); backup and protection in plain words (10).



1 Search | 2 Best ways | 3 Detail | 4 Plan set

3 · Option detail

Tapping an option opens the decision sheet.

9 Explainable chance

"On the last 10 similar Saturdays..." turns a percentage into something people can picture, and says when the final status will be known.

10 Backup and protection in plain words

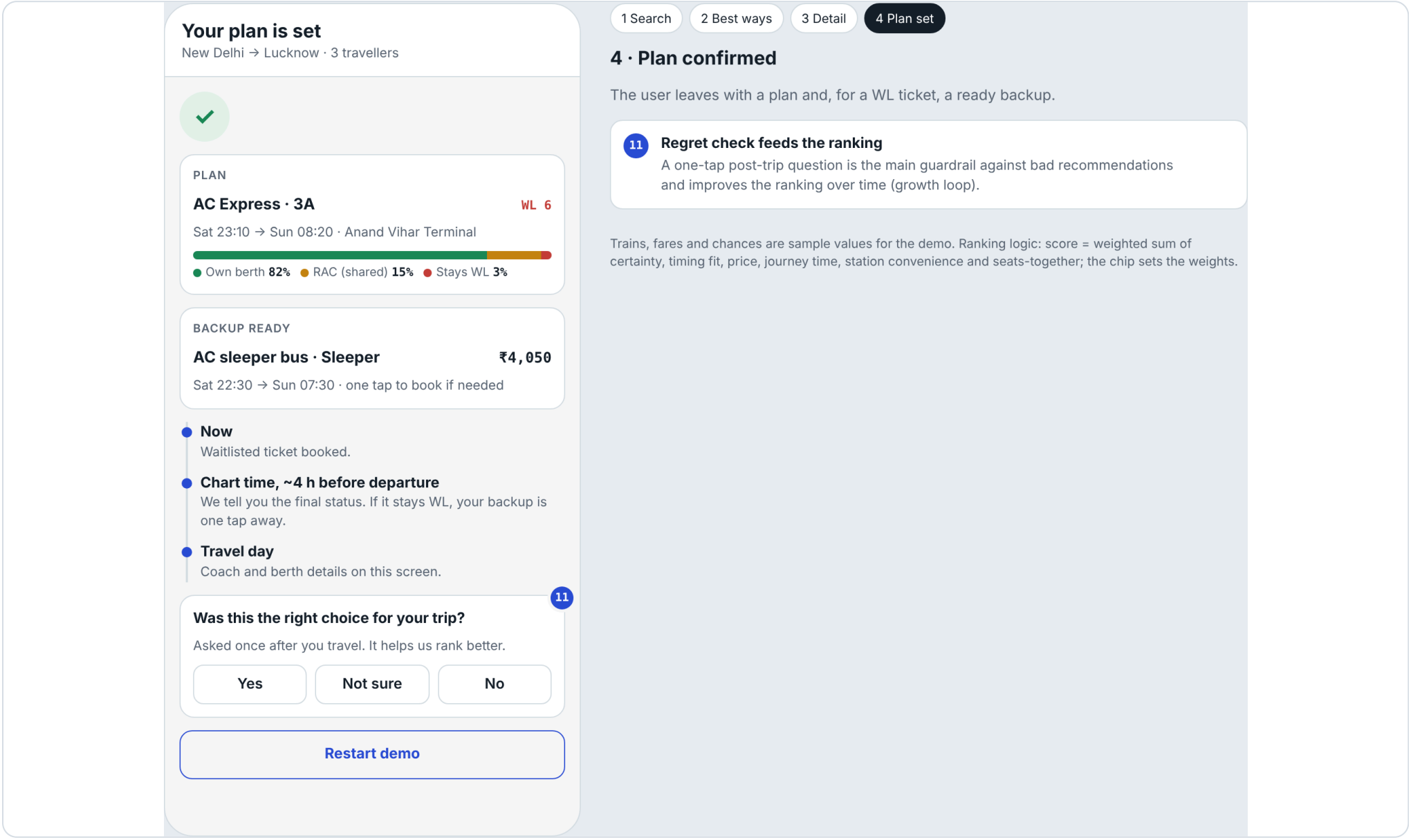
One reminder at chart time, no notification spam. Protection terms say what comes back and in what form, because 3X Refund was unknown or unclear to interviewees.

Trains, fares and chances are sample values for the demo. Ranking logic: score = weighted sum of certainty, timing fit, price, journey time, station convenience and seats-together; the chip sets the weights.

5 · PROTOTYPE · BEST-WAY-TO-REACH.LOVABLE.APP

Screen 4 · Plan set

Plan, ready backup, chart-time timeline and the post-trip regret question that feeds the ranking (11).



6 · OKRs and metric dashboard

Objective: turn a waitlisted search into a travel plan users trust, within 6 months.

KR	Key result	Baseline	Target	Source
KR1	**24-hour resolved booking rate** for users who hit WL (North Star)	26%	42%	Case brief
KR2	Trust in the shown chance (in-app pulse, 1–5)	1.7	3.5	Survey Q13
KR3	Searches before booking	3–5 for most	1–2	Survey Q8
KR4	Post-booking regret (“wrong choice”), guardrail	New	≤ 8%, not above control	Regret question
KR5	Cross-mode share of resolved bookings (bus + flight)	Today’s share	+10 pts	Booking data

North Star target path (users who see the feature)



Dashboard tiles

Resolved in 24h
26% → 42%

Trust in the %
1.7 → 3.5

Open rate of Best Way to Reach
60%

Bookings from top pick or backup
50%

Calibration gap (CNF / RAC / WL)
≤ 5 pts

90-day repeat booking
85.6% → 88%

Rollout: pilot 5% of WL users on 20 routes (months 1–2), families (month 3), all WL users (months 4–6), then the PNR page. Path values are targets, not results.

7 · Guardrails and event tracking

Guardrail	Why	Threshold
Post-booking regret	Catches bad recommendations	≤ 8%, not above control
Prediction calibration (predicted vs actual CNF, RAC, WL)	Catches overstated confidence	Gap ≤ 5 pts per bucket
Cancellation rate of recommended options	Users booked something that didn't fit	Not above control
Complaints mentioning "prediction wrong" or RAC	Trust	−30%
Page load time	Experience on 4G and low-end phones	< 2 s

Event tracking

Event	Trigger	Key properties
wl_seen	WL / no seats shown on search or booking	route, date, train, class, wl_no, pax, p_cnf, p_rac, p_wl
bwr_opened	User opens Best Way to Reach	entry_point, options_count
chip_selected	Priority chip tapped	chip, position_before, position_after
cutoff_changed	Cut-off toggled or changed	on, value, options_hidden
option_viewed	Card opened	mode, rank, price, arrive_time, certainty
option_booked	Booking completed from the list	mode, rank, label (top_pick / backup / other), fare
backup_selected	Backup kept for a WL ticket	backup_mode, trigger_time
chart_outcome	Chart prepared	final_status (CNF / RAC / WL), predicted split
regret_answered	Post-trip question answered	answer, mode, rank

8 · Raw research notes: survey

Bilingual Google Form, 18 questions; 7 responses, 6 had hit a waitlist in the last 6 months. Directional only.

Finding	Result (n = 6)
Searched 3+ times before deciding	6 of 6 (2 searched 10+)
Hardest part: too many options or too many apps	4 of 6
Trust in an app's "% chance" (1–5)	Average 1.7; nobody above 3
A 70%+ ticket ended differently	2 of the 4 who remember (1 RAC, 1 stayed WL)
Tried Tatkal for this trip	5 of 6 (3 got confirmed)
Final booking channel	IRCTC 3, ixigo 2, agent 1
Final outcome	Confirmed train 4, flight 1, agent 1
What a plan + backup must show (open text)	Confirmed seat; reserved seat; price and comfort; a good train for family comfort

What matters most (average rank, 1 = top)



Price ranked 6th of 7: time and certainty matter more.

9 · Raw research notes: interview themes and hypotheses

Themes from the interview synthesis

A	Confirmation probability is a major decision aid: personal cut-offs of 80%, 85–90% and 90%+.
B	Familiarity and trust in IRCTC hold back booking on ixigo.
C	Login and flow friction reduce repeat use for some.
D	3X Refund needs clear discovery and plain terms.
E	Users want a useful backup: flights, buses, other trains, Tatkal.
F	Priorities are personal: comfort, punctuality, speed, safety, timing.
G	Festival peaks and Tatkal add complexity.
H	Data freshness and status confidence matter.

Hypothesis check

#	Hypothesis	Verdict
H1	Can’t compare alternatives	Supported
H2	Don’t trust a bare %	Refined: relied on, not trusted
H3	Options scattered across tabs	Partly
H4	Price is not the main blocker	Supported
H5	Late panic near chart time	Partly
H6	One clear answer wins elsewhere	New angle: IRCTC habit and trust
H7	CNF vs RAC gap hurts trust	Supported

Primary barrier: low decision confidence. Users can’t compare options on their own priorities, and they lean on a percentage they don’t trust.